

3.4 Education

3.4.1 Roles and functions of education

Content	Additional information
• Different views of the role and functions of education. • The functionalist perspective of Durkheim on education as the transmission of norms and values and Parsons on achieved status and the operation of schools on meritocratic principles.	Students should be able to: • identify, describe and explain the functions of education including serving the needs of the economy, facilitating social mobility and fostering social cohesion • identify and describe a variety of different types of school including primary and secondary, state and private • describe alternative forms of educational provision including home schooling and de-schooling • describe, compare and contrast a variety of sociological perspectives on these issues (functionalist, feminist and Marxist) • describe the key ideas of Durkheim (page 47) on education • describe the key ideas of Parsons (page 48) on education.